

Apply to be a Science Corps Fellow - Entry #3345

Name
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Gender
Female
Residence: City (State), Country
Oxford, United Kingdom
Nationality
British
When did you or do you expect to complete your PhD?
June 2025
Please tell us briefly about your university education (institution, city, country, year)
I have been a DPhil student studying Accelerator Physics at the University of Oxford, Oxford, United Kingdom since 2021, due to complete my PhD this year. Previously, I completed my MSc in Accelerator Physics at the University of Liverpool, Liverpool, United Kingdom, finishing in 2021.
Why would you like to be a Science Corps Fellow?
Unfortunately, it is the case that outreach and community engagement in Physics and Engineering is seen as less important as academic results, and so I want to fully engage in a programme that nurtures this and will showcase the tremendous benefit of accessible science education to everyone. I want to expand on my experience in outreach to produce long-lasting material that encourages students from all backgrounds to consider a career in science, especially young females who still face entering predominately male fields. I have worked in some incredibly diverse environments such as working at CERN, and I believe that this only benefits the scientific community and the research that happens there. I think it is important to target underrepresented countries in a way that inspires students to want to contribute to this incredibly rewarding field that values curiosity, and independent thinking. Personally, I also want to share how exciting and relevant my own field is. Accelerator physics is a perfect example of multidisciplinary research between physicists, engineers, computer scientists and even chemist and biologists!

Accelerators exist in their tens of thousands all around the world, yet so many of us have no idea of the valuable work they contribute to: cancer treatment, pharmaceutical development to name a few. I want to help produce a programme that highlights the tangible benefits our field provides, and inspire students to look for the positive impact all STEM fields can have on society and community.

In addition to your studies, please describe any prior experience that may help you as a Science Corps Fellow.

Camp Councillor- Shanghai, China 2019-2020

From 2019-2020 I worked summers in China as a camp leader for Chinese children aged 7-14 enrolled in international schools. I led the 'Adventure' team in creating lesson and activity plans for the campers to engage in Climbing, Woodworking and tree top rope courses. This was alongside offering pastoral care and mediating conflict in what could sometimes be a high stress environment. I worked with a diverse group of staff to produce a encouraging and fulfilling environment for all the students, and navigated language and cultural barriers with patience and understanding.

Pint of Science Public Talks - 2023-2025

While living and working at CERN in Geneva, I was asked to present some of my research as part of the worldwide science festival 'Pint of Science', whereby scientists give engaging, down-to-earth talks about their science in a local bar or pub. The opportunity to create material that showcased the important and relevant research I was involved in was very much aligned with my belief that communicating research in an easy-to-access format to as many people as possible is just as important as the research itself. Since this, I have organised my own 'Pint of Science' events in my University College Bar, inviting speakers in a wide variety of fields to present their research alongside my own. It remains a highlight of the social calendar for the students and families that attend.

CERN tour guide 2022-2023

During my time as CERN completing my research, I also engaged with the huge outreach community we had as a volunteer tour guide. Using my science communication skills, and ability to adapt my explanations to all levels, I offered organised tours to the CERN visit point for the general public and schools groups. Some of these visits required adherence to strict health and safety protocols in radiation areas, where the safety of the visitors in always the most important priority.

Department Outreach 2022

I have also contributed to the outreach programme within my own particle physics department in Oxford. As part of an outreach drive to engage high schools students in accelerator physics, I was part of a team of DPhil students going into schools in the local area to present exercises for 11-15 year old students using custom made Bodhran Drums to demonstrate RF Cavity mechanisms.

Additionally, I have also contributed to the Accelerate! show, an interactive lecture all about accelerator science aimed at young students and the general public.

Where do you imagine yourself professionally in the future? Check all that apply.

Scientist in academia

Doing science in industry

In science outreach

Other

Please expand on your selection above and describe where you imagine yourself professionally in the near (~2 year) and long-term (~10 year) future.

In the near future, I am taking advantage of being at the start of my career to decide what I really want to contribute to the STEM community. I know that I find education and community engagement invaluable, having benefited from similar programmes as a high school student, and I want to be part of a group that carries on a culture of positive educational experiences at such a formative age. However, I also want to return to academic research or a technical role within a research institute in order to expand my knowledge and experience in the field, which would open up more opportunities to me in the future.

In the long term, I want to have weighed up the benefit of staying in the academic field vs using my skills in industry. I always believe I will see myself in research, in whatever form that may take, the scientific community is one which will also strive for knowledge to benefit society. Also, while not necessarily my main focus I will always seek to use my background as a platform for engaging as many people as possible in science. I think it is important to keep my own passion and drive for my research in order to pass this along to other people. It would be incredibly rewarding to establish a programme for outreach alongside whatever role I pursue.

Please upload your CV (.pdf)

 [Non-Academic-CV-SPEAR.pdf](#)

How did you find out about Science Corps?

An email list in your institution

[Science Corps](#)